

H1 Pattern Analysis - 5 Years of NQ Futures

December 2020 - December 2025 | All Times NY | Sundays Excluded

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Metric	Value
Total Trades Analyzed	26,706
Date Range	Dec 7, 2020 - Dec 5, 2025
Overall Win Rate	71.2%
Continuation Win Rate	73.0% (16,323/22,358)
Reversal Win Rate	61.8% (2,686/4,348)
Avg DOL Minute	:09
Median Adverse Before DOL	4.2 pts

IMPORTANT: TRIGGER HOUR vs TRADE HOUR

The trigger hour is the H1 candle that creates the pattern. The trade is executed in the NEXT hour.

If Trigger Hour Is	Pattern Forms At	Trade Window Is
02:00 NY	02:00-02:59	03:00-03:59
08:00 NY	08:00-08:59	09:00-09:59
15:00 NY	15:00-15:59	16:00-16:59

When we say "02:00 has 77.8% win rate," we mean:

- The H1 candle closing at 02:59 sets up the pattern
- You enter at 03:00 when the new hour opens
- You look for DOL to be taken during 03:00-03:59

1. PATTERN WIN RATES

Pattern	Win Rate	Occurrences	Avg DOL Min	Median Adverse
Bullish Continuation	73.8%	11,973	:09	4.2 pts

Pattern	Win Rate	Occurrences	Avg DOL Min	Median Adverse
Bearish Continuation	72.1%	10,385	:10	4.2 pts
Bullish Reversal	63.8%	1,886	:15	—
Bearish Reversal	60.2%	2,462	:17	—

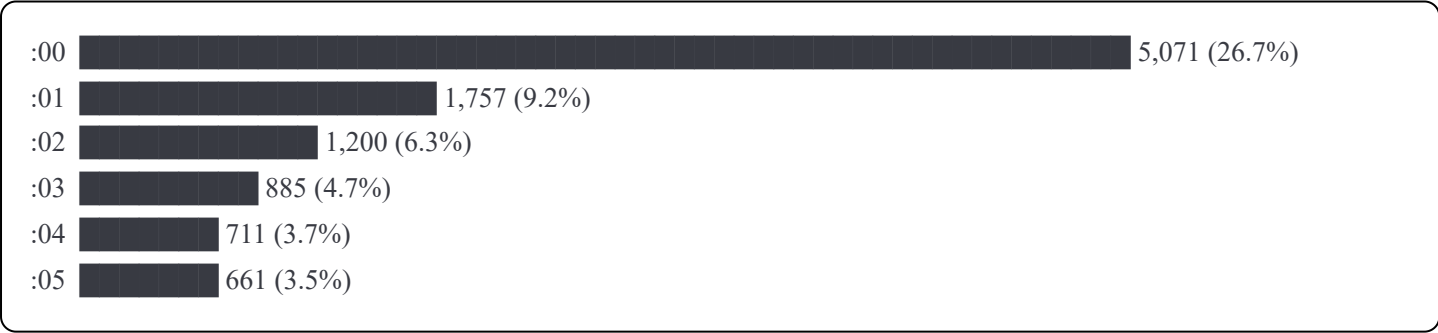
Key Insight: Continuations outperform reversals by ~12%. Focus on continuation patterns only.

2. DOL TIMING DISTRIBUTION

When does the DOL get taken in the trade hour?

Time Into Trade Hour	Cumulative %	Insight
:00 (first minute)	26.7%	1 in 4 hit immediately
Within :02	42.2%	~42% in first 3 mins
Within :05	54.1%	Majority within 5 mins
Within :10	66.4%	2/3 within 10 mins
Within :15	73.9%	~74% within 15 mins
Within :30	87.9%	~88% within 30 mins
Within :45	95.6%	Almost all by 45 mins

Visual Distribution (5,071 trades hit at :00)



3. TIME CUTOFF ANALYSIS

"If X minutes pass without DOL being taken, what are the odds it eventually hits?"

Minutes Passed	Trades Past This	Eventually Hit DOL	Success Rate
:05	16,421	8,724	53.1%
:10	14,084	6,387	45.3%
:15	12,650	4,953	39.2%
:20	11,636	3,939	33.9%
:30	10,003	2,306	23.1%
:45	8,534	837	9.8%

Trade Management Rules

- **If :10 passes:** Only 45% chance → Consider scratching
- **If :15 passes:** Only 39% chance → Strong case to exit
- **If :30 passes:** Only 23% chance → Should be out
- **If :45 passes:** Only 10% chance → Dead trade

4. WIN RATE BY TRIGGER HOUR (Continuations Only)

Trigger	Trade Window	Bull Cont	Bear Cont	Combined	Avg Min
00:00	01:00-:59	434/542 (80%)	403/522 (77%)	78.7% (837/1064)	:09 ★
01:00	02:00-:59	463/577 (80%)	403/514 (78%)	79.4% (866/1091)	:07 ★
02:00	03:00-:59	447/583 (77%)	396/501 (79%)	77.8% (843/1084)	:06 ★
03:00	04:00-:59	388/590 (66%)	310/482 (64%)	65.1% (698/1072)	:08 ⚠
04:00	05:00-:59	376/556 (68%)	362/551 (66%)	66.7% (738/1107)	:11 ⚠
05:00	06:00-:59	413/577 (72%)	352/480 (73%)	72.4% (765/1057)	:10
06:00	07:00-:59	435/566 (77%)	349/491 (71%)	74.2% (784/1057)	:08
07:00	08:00-:59	445/561 (79%)	403/512 (79%)	79.0% (848/1073)	:10 ★
08:00	09:00-:59	476/557 (85%)	469/555 (85%)	85.0% (945/1112)	:14 ★★
09:00	10:00-:59	468/588 (80%)	389/503 (77%)	78.6% (857/1091)	:06 ★
10:00	11:00-:59	422/576 (73%)	362/527 (69%)	71.1% (784/1103)	:09
11:00	12:00-:59	442/640 (69%)	354/468 (76%)	71.8% (796/1108)	:10
12:00	13:00-:59	466/594 (78%)	340/471 (72%)	75.7% (806/1065)	:09 ★
13:00	14:00-:59	444/582 (76%)	322/440 (73%)	75.0% (766/1022)	:09
14:00	15:00-:59	472/602 (78%)	340/440 (77%)	77.9% (812/1042)	:10 ★
15:00	16:00-:59	292/533 (55%)	287/518 (55%)	55.1% (579/1051)	:05 ⚠⚠
18:00	19:00-:59	303/448 (68%)	284/414 (69%)	68.1% (587/862)	:13 ⚠

Trigger	Trade Window	Bull Cont	Bear Cont	Combined	Avg Min
19:00	20:00-:59	337/448 (75%)	294/403 (73%)	74.1% (631/851)	:07
20:00	21:00-:59	345/484 (71%)	273/406 (67%)	69.4% (618/890)	:12 ⚠️
21:00	22:00-:59	318/459 (69%)	264/392 (67%)	68.4% (582/851)	:11 ⚠️
22:00	23:00-:59	308/443 (70%)	267/410 (65%)	67.4% (575/853)	:11 ⚠️
23:00	00:00-:59	337/467 (72%)	269/385 (70%)	71.1% (606/852)	:11

5. YOUR KEY HOURS ANALYSIS

02:00 NY Trigger → Trade in 03:00-03:59 ⭐

Metric	Value
Combined Win Rate	77.8% (843/1,084)
Bullish Continuation	76.7% (447/583)
Bearish Continuation	79.0% (396/501)
Avg DOL Minute	:06 (fast!)
Avg Adverse Before DOL	46.4 pts
Sample Size	1,084 trades over 5 years

Verdict: ✅ Strong edge confirmed. Both directions work. Fast DOL timing.

03:00 NY Trigger → Trade in 04:00-04:59 ⚠️

Metric	Value
Combined Win Rate	65.1% (698/1,072)
Bullish Continuation	65.8% (388/590)
Bearish Continuation	64.3% (310/482)
Avg DOL Minute	:08
Avg Adverse Before DOL	7.4 pts
Sample Size	1,072 trades over 5 years

Verdict: ⚠️ Below average. Not recommended as a primary setup.

6. TOP 5 & BOTTOM 5 TRIGGER HOURS

TOP 5 (Best Setups)

Rank	Trigger	Trade Window	Win Rate	Sample
1	08:00	09:00-09:59	85.0%	1,112
2	01:00	02:00-02:59	79.4%	1,091
3	07:00	08:00-08:59	79.0%	1,073
4	00:00	01:00-01:59	78.7%	1,064
5	09:00	10:00-10:59	78.6%	1,091

BOTTOM 5 (Avoid)

Rank	Trigger	Trade Window	Win Rate	Sample
1	15:00	16:00-16:59	55.1%	1,051
2	03:00	04:00-04:59	65.1%	1,072
3	04:00	05:00-05:59	66.7%	1,107
4	22:00	23:00-23:59	67.4%	853
5	18:00	19:00-19:59	68.1%	862

7. DAY OF WEEK

Day	Win Rate	Occurrences	Avg DOL Min
Thursday	74.5%	4,770	:10
Tuesday	73.0%	4,774	:09
Wednesday	72.9%	4,776	:10
Friday	72.6%	3,388	:09
Monday	71.9%	4,650	:09

All days are relatively consistent (71.9% - 74.5%). Thursday slightly best.

8. ENTRY POSITION VS TRUE DAY OPEN

Entry Position	Long Signals	Short Signals
Above TDO	74.1% (5,651/7,628)	71.4% (2,692/3,770)
Below TDO	72.2% (2,731/3,783)	72.2% (4,390/6,079)

Trading Filter

- **Longs above TDO:** 74.1% → Slightly better
- **Longs below TDO:** 72.2% → Still tradeable
- **Shorts work similarly regardless of TDO position**

9. RETRACEMENT ANALYSIS (Adverse Excursion Before DOL)

How much does price move against you before hitting DOL?

Statistic	Value
Mean	8.9 pts
Median	4.2 pts
75th Percentile	10.2 pts
90th Percentile	21.8 pts
95th Percentile	32.5 pts

Retracement Distribution

Bucket	% of Winners
0-5 pts	53.5%
5-10 pts	20.5%
10-15 pts	9.5%
15-20 pts	5.2%
20-30 pts	5.5%
30-50 pts	3.8%
50+ pts	2.0%

Stop Loss Guidance

- **10 pt stop:** Catches ~74% of winners
- **15 pt stop:** Catches ~84% of winners
- **22 pt stop:** Catches ~90% of winners
- **33 pt stop:** Catches ~95% of winners

10. DOL TIMING BY TRIGGER HOUR

Trigger	Trade Window	Avg	Median	<:05	<:15	<:30
00:00	01:00-:59	:09	:03	58%	76%	89%
01:00	02:00-:59	:07	:02	66%	84%	93%
02:00	03:00-:59	:06	:02	68%	84%	94%
03:00	04:00-:59	:08	:03	60%	81%	92%
08:00	09:00-:59	:14	:08	44%	62%	82%
09:00	10:00-:59	:06	:01	68%	84%	93%
15:00	16:00-:59	:05	:00	78%	87%	94%

Fastest DOL: 15:00 trigger (but only 55% win rate - avoid!) **Best combo:** 02:00 trigger - high win rate AND fast DOL

11. COMPLETE TRADING STRATEGY

Entry Criteria (A+ Setups)

- 1. **Pattern:** Continuation ONLY (73% vs 62% win rate)
- 2. **Trigger Hours** (ranked by edge):
 - 08:00 → Trade 09:00-09:59 (85.0%) ★★
 - 01:00 → Trade 02:00-02:59 (79.4%) ★
 - 07:00 → Trade 08:00-08:59 (79.0%) ★
 - 00:00 → Trade 01:00-01:59 (78.7%) ★
 - 02:00 → Trade 03:00-03:59 (77.8%) ★
 - 09:00 → Trade 10:00-10:59 (78.6%) ★
- 3. **Day:** Any day (Thursday marginally best)
- 4. **Optional Filter:** Longs above TDO (+2% edge)

Hours to AVOID

- **15:00 trigger** (16:00 trade): Only 55% - worse than coin flip
- 03:00 trigger (04:00 trade): 65%
- 04:00 trigger (05:00 trade): 67%
- Evening session (18:00-22:00 triggers): 67-69%

Trade Execution

- 1. **Entry:** First candle of trade hour (:00)
- 2. **Target:** Previous H1 high (longs) or low (shorts) = DOL
- 3. **Stop Loss Options:**
 - Conservative: 10 pts (catches 74% of winners)
 - Standard: 15 pts (catches 84% of winners)
 - Wide: 22 pts (catches 90% of winners)

Time-Based Exit Rules

If DOL not hit by...	Action
:10	Consider scratching (45% remaining)
:15	Strong exit signal (39% remaining)
:30	Exit (23% remaining)
:45	Must be out (10% remaining)

Expected Performance

- **Win Rate:** 73-85% depending on hour
- **Avg Time in Trade:** ~9 minutes
- **Median Adverse:** 4.2 pts
- **DOL hit in first 5 mins:** 54%

12. STATISTICAL NOTES

- **Sample Size:** 26,706 trades (22,358 continuations)
- **Period:** 5 years (Dec 2020 - Dec 2025)
- ~1,000+ **samples per hour** for reliable statistics
- **Sundays excluded** from all analysis
- **All times are New York (ET/EST)**
- **Front month contracts** used throughout

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

BEST TRIGGERS (≥78%):

- 08:00 → 09:xx (85%) ★ ★
- 01:00 → 02:xx (79%)
- 07:00 → 08:xx (79%)
- 00:00 → 01:xx (79%)
- 09:00 → 10:xx (79%)
- 02:00 → 03:xx (78%) ← YOUR EDGE CONFIRMED

AVOID (<70%):

- 15:00 → 16:xx (55%) ⚠ ⚠
- 03:00 → 04:xx (65%)
- 04:00 → 05:xx (67%)
- 22:00 → 23:xx (67%)

TIME STOPS:

:10 = 45% chance | :15 = 39% | :30 = 23% | :45 = 10%

STOPS:

10pt = 74% | 15pt = 84% | 22pt = 90%